

The Soup Cookbook for Seniors - Printable Charts

From *The Soup Cookbook for Seniors* by Laura Bennett (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need; the sheets are sized for the fridge door.

The Stock Comparison

Sodium in a cup (240 ml) of stock, made up, and what it does to a bowl of soup.

Stock	Sodium a cup	In a two-bowl soup with 3 cups, per bowl
Your own, from bones or scraps	About 20 mg	30 mg
Very-low-salt cubes or pots (what this book assumes)	About 150 mg	220 mg
"Reduced-salt" cubes, typical	300 to 600 mg	450 to 900 mg
Ordinary stock cubes	About 1,000 mg	1,500 mg
Ready-made carton stock, typical	300 to 800 mg	450 to 1,200 mg
For comparison: a can of condensed soup, one serving	700 to 900 mg	
The day's limit for most people over sixty	1,500 to 2,300 mg	

Thickening: Five Ways

Method	How	Best for
A potato	One medium, diced, cooked in the soup, blended or mashed	Vegetable and chicken soups
Beans or lentils	A ladle of the soup blended and stirred back, or red lentils cooked in	Bean soups, any thin soup
Blending	The whole soup with a hand blender	Vegetable soups
Cornflour	1 tbsp in 2 tbsp cold water, stirred into the simmering soup for 2 minutes	Chowders, milky soups
Egg	1 or 2 beaten eggs whisked in off the heat, never boiled after	The Greek and Italian soups

Seasoning Without Salt

What a bland soup needs, in the order to try it.

It needs	Add	How much
Sharpness (first, nearly always)	Lemon or lime juice, cider or wine vinegar	1 tsp at a time
Freshness	Parsley, coriander, dill, basil, chives, mint	A handful, at the end
Warmth	Black pepper, chilli flakes, more of the spice used at the start	A pinch at a time
Depth	Soy sauce, Worcestershire sauce, mustard, tomato puree, miso, parmesan	1 tsp at a time
Sweetness	A pinch of sugar, an apple, a carrot, a roasted pepper	In tomato and root soups
Richness	A spoon of olive oil, butter, yogurt or cream stirred into the bowl	1 tsp to 1 tbsp
Salt	Last, if still needed	A pinch

The Freezer Chart

Cool within two hours; single portions; a finger's width of room at the top; label with the name and the date; three months for the best taste; thaw overnight in the fridge; reheat to bubbling right through, once.

Freezes well	Freezes with a change	Do not freeze
Chicken, meat, bean, lentil, split pea and barley soups	Soups with pasta, rice or noodles: freeze the soup, cook the pasta fresh	Fish and shellfish soups (make fresh; the fish goes woolly)
Blended vegetable soups (tomato, carrot, squash, pea, lentil)	Soups with milk or cream: freeze before it goes in, add when reheating (or blend after thawing if it splits)	Egg-thickened soups (the Greek and Italian ones)
Tomato-based soups and the chillies	Soups with potato chunks: potato goes mealy; blend it in, or accept it	The chilled soups with raw cucumber (gazpacho is fine)
Stocks and broths (in cup-sized tubs, or ice-cube trays for a splash)	Soups with yogurt or cheese stirred in: add fresh	Soups with a lot of green leaves added at the end (add fresh)
Dal, harira, minestrone (without the pasta)	Soups with dumplings: freeze the soup, make the dumplings fresh	

The Safety Rules

1. Cool it fast, then refrigerate within two hours: shallow tubs, lids off until the steam stops, the pot in a sink of cold water.
2. Three days in the fridge, covered and dated; longer, the freezer.
3. Freeze in single portions, flat, labelled; three months for the best taste.
4. Reheat to bubbling right through (74C / 165F), stirred; reheat a portion once only.
5. Fish, shellfish and egg soups: eaten the day they are made.
6. Slow cooker: thaw meat first; canned beans, or dried ones boiled hard for ten minutes; never reheat in it.
7. Ladle at the hob; carry the bowl, not the pan; the hand blender off the heat with the blade under the surface.
8. A dry or numb mouth does not feel heat: let it stand a minute and test it on the wrist.

The Weekly Soup Planner

Day	Soup	Made or frozen	With
Mon			
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			

My Soups

Soup	What I changed	How it went